

PARTICIPANT INFORMATION SHEET AND INFORMED CONSENT FORM

Project title: Structure in Thought

Lead researcher: Timon Kunze (tkunze@sissa.it)

Principal investigator: Davide Crepaldi

Co-Investigator: Mona Garvert

Institution: International School for Advanced Studies (SISSA), Trieste, Italy

What is this document?

This document explains what kind of study we are conducting, what your rights are, and how your data will be processed. You may keep this document for your records. Before deciding if you want to participate in this study, you should read this information carefully and ask the researcher any questions you might have using Prolific's messaging tool or by sending an email to: tkunze@sissa.it.

Nature of the study

We are investigating how people represent knowledge in their mind and brain.

Procedure

There are two main parts to the experiment. In the first part on the first day, we will show you a 2-dimensional environment on the screen that depicts flowers. We ask you to click on these flowers and search for a bee that is hidden insight them. After each trial we ask you a question about what you have seen. The second part takes place one day later. That day, we will ask you some additional questions about what you have seen earlier.

Compensation

The total completion time is estimated to be 1 hour, about 35 minutes for the first part and about 25 minutes for the second part. You will be paid £9.00, which equates to an hourly rate of £9.00 and is in line with what Prolific recommends as a fair pay policy at the time of this study.

Risks and benefits

There are no known risks to taking part in this study, and there are no benefits beyond the financial compensation for your time.

Confidentiality and the use of your data

During the experiment, we will record various pieces of information about your performance on the task, such as your button clicks and reaction times. We will analyze this data only for the stated purposes of this study. We will *not* collect any personal information about you, such as your name or geographic location. The only piece of identifying information we collect is your Prolific participant ID. This is so that we can pay you and so that we can delete your data should you wish to withdraw from the study in the future.



The anonymous data we collect from you will be stored on a secure web server located in Hessen (Germany), later it will be moved to our personal computers, and to secure servers maintained by SISSA in Trieste, Italy. Eventually, the data will be made freely and publicly available in research archives or in scientific publications along with that of many other participants. However, we will *never* disclose your Prolific participant ID, nor any other personal information.

You may withdraw your data at any time up to 31 August 2023 by writing to tkunze@sisa.it without having to provide an explanation. After this we cannot guarantee that your fully anonymous data will not have been placed in the public domain.

More generally, your data will be processed in accordance with the General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR) of the European Union. You have the right to access the information we hold about you, and you also have rights of correction, erasure, and objection. Questions, comments, or requests about the data we have collected or about your rights may be addressed to SISSA's Data Protection Officer (DPO), Valentina Carollo, by emailing: dpo@sisa.it or rdp@sisa.it – PEC: protocollo@pec.sisa.it.

Voluntary participation and the right to withdraw from the study

Your participation in this research project is entirely voluntary. If you withdraw from the study during data collection, we will delete your data at that time. Note however, that in some circumstances, you will not get paid in accordance with the guidelines of Prolific.

By accepting and participating in this study, you agree to the following:

1. I confirm that I am at least 18 years old.
2. I have read the above information relating to the purpose and procedures of the study.
3. I have been informed about the aims and objectives of this research.
4. I have had the opportunity to ask questions about the experimental procedure and I have obtained satisfactory answers.
5. I am aware of any risks related to taking part in this experiment.
6. I have received satisfactory assurances on the confidentiality of my data.
7. I understand that the anonymous data I produce may be kept permanently in archives and made freely available online.
8. I am aware that I am free to withdraw from this study at any stage.

23rd May 2024,

